

1. Get the ball rolling

- How do you usually *get the ball rolling* on a new project at work?
- Who should *get the ball rolling* in a team: the manager or the team members? Why?

2. Start / Get off on the right foot

- What helps a team *get off on the right foot* when starting a new project?
- Have you ever started a job on the wrong foot? What happened?

3. Bring something to the table

- What skills do you bring to the table in a professional environment?
- What do you expect a good leader to bring to the table?

4. From the ground up

- Have you ever helped build something *from the ground up*?
- What are the biggest challenges of creating a business from the ground up?

5. Get down to business

- In meetings, how do you usually *get down to business*?
- Do you prefer small talk before meetings or getting straight down to business?

6. Think outside the box

- Can you give an example of a time when you had to *think outside the box* at work?
- Do companies really encourage creativity, or is “think outside the box” just a slogan?

7. By the book

- Is it better to do things *by the book* or adapt when necessary?
- Have you ever worked in a company that followed everything strictly by the book?

8. Rock the boat

- Is it ever positive to *rock the boat* in a company?
- Would you speak up if you disagreed with your manager, even if it rocked the boat?

9. On the ball

- What makes someone look *on the ball* at work? > delay/postpone
- How do you stay on the ball when you're under pressure?

10. Throw in the towel

- What would make someone *throw in the towel* professionally?
- Have you ever thought about throwing in the towel on a project or job?

11. On the same page

- How do you make sure everyone is *on the same page* in a team?
- What problems happen when people are not on the same page?

12. Word of mouth

- How important is *word of mouth* for a business today?
- Have you ever chosen a service mainly because of word of mouth?

13. Behind the scenes

- What kind of work usually happens *behind the scenes* in a company?
- Do you think behind-the-scenes work is valued enough? Why or why not?

Follow the rules or rock the boat?

Controversial statement:

Companies should always work *by the book*. Rocking the boat creates unnecessary risks.

Key idioms:

by the book · *rock the boat* · *think outside the box* · *get down to business*

Debate questions:

- Is following the rules always the safest option in business?
- Can innovation exist without rocking the boat?
- When does “thinking outside the box” become a risk?

Success from the ground up or shortcuts?

Controversial statement:

Building success *from the ground up* is overrated. Networking and *word of mouth* matter more.

Key idioms:

from the ground up · word of mouth · bring something to the table · behind the scenes

Debate questions:

- Is building a career or business from the ground up still realistic today?
- How powerful is word of mouth compared to skills and experience?
- What matters more in business: what you bring to the table or who you know?
- How much of success really happens behind the scenes?

When should you throw in the towel?**Controversial statement:**

Quitting a project is a failure. You should never throw in the towel.

Key idioms:

throw in the towel · get off on the right foot · on the ball · on the same page

Debate questions:

- When is throwing in the towel the smartest professional decision?
- Is a bad start enough reason to give up, or can teams still get off on the right foot?
- How does being on the ball help prevent failure?
- What happens when a team is not on the same page?

14. Hit the nail on the head

- When was the last time a colleague really *hit the nail on the head* during a meeting?
- Why is it important to hit the nail on the head when presenting a problem to management?

15. Raise the bar

- How can leaders *raise the bar* without demotivating their teams?
- Has your company ever raised the bar? What changed after that?

16. Back to square one

- What usually causes a project to go *back to square one*?
- How do teams stay motivated when they have to go back to square one?

17. (Straight) from the horse's mouth

- Why is getting information *straight from the horse's mouth* important in business?
- Do you prefer official communication or information from colleagues? Why?

18. Keep you on your toes

- How does a fast-changing market *keep companies on their toes*?
- Do strict deadlines help keep employees on their toes or create stress?

19. Read between the lines

- Why is it important to *read between the lines* in emails and meetings?
- Have you ever misunderstood a situation because you didn't read between the lines?

20. Give the thumbs up

- Who usually *gives the thumbs up* on decisions in your workplace?
- What happens when a project doesn't get the thumbs up from leadership?

21. Back to the drawing board

- When should a team go *back to the drawing board* instead of fixing small problems?
- Is going back to the drawing board a failure or a strategic decision?

22. Give someone a pat on the back

- How important is it to *give employees a pat on the back*?
- Can recognition be more effective than financial rewards?

23. Twist someone's arm

- Is it ever acceptable to *twist someone's arm* to meet a deadline?

- What are the risks of forcing people to agree with a decision?

24. Keep one's eye on the ball

- How do entrepreneurs *keep their eye on the ball* when managing multiple projects?
- What distractions make it hard to keep your eye on the ball at work?

25. Do something / go behind someone's back

- What problems arise when decisions are made *behind someone's back*?
- How can companies avoid a culture of going behind people's backs?